Daniel Rickey

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Cloud Infrastructure & AI Engineer

US citizen · able to pass a criminal background check · open to remote, on-site, and travel

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cloud infrastructure and AI engineer who builds and runs production AWS services and multi-agent AI systems on self-managed Linux. Built and operates the AWS stack behind a live consulting site and an AI tutor service (AWS Lambda calling the Anthropic API), and designed a coordinated system of 40+ Claude Code agents with its own Python/SQLite logging backend, browser-based operations console, and read-only monitoring. AWS training and work since 2017. Builds with AI as the primary code author: design, review, iterative testing, and fault diagnosis are my own, and output is cross-checked across multiple AI tools.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud (AWS): EC2, S3, CloudFront, Route 53, Lambda, API Gateway, SES, IAM (resource-scoped least-privilege policies), VPC

Automation & deployment: AWS CLI (agent-driven), deployment scripts, Bash, cron, Git **[NEEDS EVIDENCE: Terraform / CloudFormation / CDK]**

Linux & virtualization: Linux server administration, Linux virtualization with isolated VMs, network segmentation, server hardening, tmux, systemd

Languages (AI-assisted development; read, review, debug): Python (asyncio, websockets, pty, SQLite), Bash, JavaScript / Node.js

AI & LLM systems: Anthropic Messages API, Claude Code (interactive and headless stream-json mode), multi-agent orchestration, agent permission scoping, independent multi-agent review

Data: SQLite schema design and live migration, MySQL administration

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS and domain lifecycle, routing & switching, wireless, Cisco

Certifications in progress: CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) | AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (SAA-C03) | Claude Certified Architect – Foundations (CCAR-F)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

San Diego Cloud Solutions **2026 – Present**

Founder & Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

- Built and operate production AWS infrastructure for sandiegoai.help: an Eleventy static site on S3 + CloudFront, Route 53 DNS, and SES custom-domain email, with live Square checkout on listed services; initial setup through the console, with the site rebuild and newer features delivered by Claude Code driving the AWS CLI
- Deployed Sabia, an AI tutor service: a Node.js AWS Lambda calling the Anthropic Messages API, shipped through a scripted AWS CLI deployment with a resource-scoped least-privilege IAM policy
- Separated development and production AWS accounts, enforced MFA on root and all team-member roles, and created dedicated agent roles with their own credentials so AI agents operate under scoped access
- Administer DNS configuration, domain lifecycle, and access controls across client-facing applications and AWS services
- Built and launched San Diego AI HELP, an AI consulting offering for San Diego small businesses: audit-driven service design, AI automation workflows, and live Square checkout on listed services
- Published Solo Builder's Meta-System, a paid guide + template pack, taken from design to launch in two weeks with the purchase flow tested end to end
- Designing an AI-powered conversational intake system on existing Lambda/API Gateway infrastructure, with an RDS-backed data layer planned

Vons Companies, Inc. **2022 – 2025**

Managing Clerk

- Led and developed a team in a high-throughput environment, supervising 6 direct reports with person-in-charge responsibility for approximately 12 additional staff across departments
- Managed inventory systems and operational data for $100K+ in daily product volume, minimizing loss and maintaining accuracy
- Trusted as designated key holder responsible for critical access controls and opening/closing operations

Harmony Home Medical, Inc. **2022**

Repair & Installation Technician

- Diagnosed and repaired electromechanical mobility equipment including power wheelchairs and scooters, applying systematic troubleshooting methodology
- Installed accessibility systems at residential and commercial sites, coordinating scheduling and providing direct customer technical support

Mitac, Inc. **2021**

Audio/Video Production Engineer

- Configured and deployed full A/V infrastructure for a corporate hybrid live/video-conference sales event, integrating IP networking with A/V-over-IP systems
- Operated and monitored live A/V systems throughout the event, ensuring uninterrupted broadcast and in-room experience

Illumanonymous, LLC **2019 – 2021**

Cloud Infrastructure Engineer

- Designed and deployed AWS-based infrastructure for an early-stage venture, taking one of two domains from development into production
- Deployed and administered a self-hosted NextCloud environment with phone app implementation, providing private file sync and collaboration independent of third-party hosting
- Managed DNS configuration and domain lifecycle across the venture's domains, ensuring uptime and routing reliability

TECHNICAL DEVELOPMENT PATH

The R&D foundation behind San Diego Cloud Solutions and San Diego AI HELP, current AI-assisted architecture and infrastructure work, grown out of earlier virtualization and systems experience below.

Meta-System **2026 – Present**

- Designed and run a coordinated system of 40+ scoped Claude Code agents: one orchestrating instance that advises but executes nothing, isolated per-project agents governed by version-controlled context files, and a shared activity log every project writes to; it oversees its own development alongside several live websites
- Built the browser-based operations console (Meta-System 2.0, 84 commits Jul–Sep 2026; continued as 3.0, 60 commits Aug–Oct): a Python asyncio server bridging real pty terminals over authenticated WebSockets, with tmux-backed sessions that survive a closed tab or backend restart and 14 panes built against one shared contract
- Streamed Claude Code output into the console by running headless turns in stream-json mode and translating each event for the browser
- Hardened the WebSocket handshake with Origin and token validation, verified against live authentication-rejection tests rather than code review alone
- Built the shared logging backend (devlog-engine) in Python and SQLite: schema designed against a real 88-entry dataset, migrated live with two bugs caught and fixed mid-migration, now the system of record with generated Markdown exports, backups, and integrity checks
- Put architecture decisions through independent multi-agent review before building; a unanimous panel reversed the original MySQL choice to SQLite before further work
- Diagnosed a post-reboot failure where the console's terminal server would not start under cron, traced it to missing TERM and SHELL in cron's environment, fixed both, and verified the fix across a reboot on a separate test VM
- Run a read-only cron monitor that reports health across every repo with zero write permissions, under a staged automation rule (manual → prompted → drafted → autonomous) that keeps guardrails ahead of capability

- Validate AI-generated code by testing each feature at every iteration, reviewing output for characteristic AI errors, and running results through a second AI tool to compare approaches and reasoning
- First outside deployment: a business partner installed Meta-System, developed in a Linux VM, on Windows via Ubuntu on WSL2, and uses it to run her business; now evaluating it for resale as a purpose-built tool for sales professionals in her industry. Preparing a public beta release

AI Foundations Lab **2026 – Present**

- Developing a browser-based AI literacy course platform with a named AI instructor persona (Sabia), backed by the Lambda service above, guiding students through a structured module-unlock curriculum
- Designed a hybrid delivery model with a live Sabia chat interface, platform-side artifact storage, student accounts, and dual-mode support for browser-based and local (Claude Desktop) tracks

Portable Cloud Architecture **2024 – Present**

- Operate a portable, self-managed Linux infrastructure environment for web hosting, development, AI experimentation, and remote access, modeled on the virtualization platform below
- Run isolated experimental and testing VMs alongside primary work, with VM-level sandboxing protecting the host; serves as the operating environment for the Meta-System above

Multi-Role Virtualization Platform **2021 – 2023**

- Designed and deployed a private cloud environment using Linux virtualization, network segmentation, and self-hosted services to replicate enterprise infrastructure patterns
- Provisioned a dedicated VM as a local file server and additional VMs for experimental and testing workloads, using VM-level sandboxing to contain configuration errors and failed installations
- Configured physical and virtual network routing with emphasis on security, segmentation, and performance

TECHNICAL TRAINING

San Diego College of Continuing Education **2012 – 2020**

Coursework: Cybersecurity, Linux Administration, Python Programming, Cisco Networking, MySQL Administration, Web Server Security, Virtual Datacenter Administration

A Cloud Guru (formerly Linux Academy) **2017 – 2019**

Training: AWS Fundamentals, Linux System Administration, Systemd Administration, Kali Linux, Red Hat Systems Administration

Cisco Live – Dream Team **2015**

Competitively selected from the Cisco Networking Academy student body for a week-long paid deployment supporting the Cisco Live Network Operation Center across 2,500,000 sq. ft. of convention and hotel space.

- Installed wireless access points and CAT5e infrastructure throughout the San Diego Convention Center and adjacent hotels, and supported live network operations under senior Cisco engineers